

PAKISTAN

Consulting Services for Regional Infrastructure Fund for Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (RIF-II) for Resilient Resource Management in Cities

Quarterly Progress Report 01

Reporting period August 2024 – October 2024

Project Number: BMZ No. 2018 68 355 / KfW ID: 42975 Procurement Number 508317

Co-Financing: KfW Development Bank, Frankfurt/Germany

Client:

Planning and Development Department (P&DD)
of the Provincial Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Submitted by:

Dorsch Impact GmbH - NEC - CYNOSURE

**CYNOSURE**

As Sub-Consultant:



Table of contents

1.	Executive Summary	1
2.	Project Background	5
2.1.	General	5
2.2.	Geographical Locations and Clustering:	6
2.3.	Road Commutations	8
2.4.	Methodology	8
3.	RIF II Result Matrix	11
3.1.	Overall Output Progress	11
3.2.	Activity Matrix	12
3.2.1.	Activity A Progress	12
3.2.2.	Activity Progress Output B	12
3.2.3.	Activity Progress Output C	13
4.	Project Implementation	14
4.1.	Project Inception Phase	14
4.2.	Kick-off Workshop	15
4.3.	Briefing for Tehsils Administration	16
4.4.	Educational Visit to RRM Mansehra	16
4.5.	Field Visits	16
4.6.	Stakeholders Contacts – Preliminary Feedback	17
4.6.1.	District Administration	17
4.6.2.	Public Health Engineering Department	17
4.6.3.	Tehsil Municipal Administration (TMA)	17
4.6.4.	Water and Sanitation Services Company (WSSC)	18
4.7.	TORs for Civil Society Organization	18
4.8.	Context and Institutional Assessment	18
4.8.1.	Cluster – 1	19
4.8.2.	Cluster – 2	19
4.9.	Administration and Logistics	19
4.9.1.	Hiring Office Building	19
4.9.2.	Project Transport	19
5.	Financial Information	21
5.1.	Consultancy Budget	21
5.2.	Reimbursables	21
5.3.	Disposition Fund	21
5.4.	Procurement	21
6.	ESHS Performance	22

7.	Quality Management	23
8.	Challenges	24
8.1.	Security.....	24
8.2.	Road Travel Conditions	24
8.3.	Potential Military Operations	25
8.4.	Project Leadership and Administration	25
8.5.	Engagement of CSO	25
8.6.	Restrictions on Foreign Visitors	25
8.7.	Political Influences	26
9.	Risk Assessment and Prospect of Achieving the Overall Project Goals	27
10.	Outlook and Recommendations	29
10.1.	Bannu Kick-off Workshop	29
10.2.	Institutional Assessment and Context and Physical Assessment.....	29
10.3.	Coordination with Experts	29
10.4.	Hiring of CSO	29

List of annexes

Annex 1:	Letter of Introduction	31
Annex 2:	Kick-off Meeting – Invitation Letter	32
Annex 3:	List of Invitees / Attendees	33
Annex 4:	Schedule of Kick-Off Meeting	35
Annex 5:	Photo Documentation of Kick-Off Meeting	36
Annex 6:	Questions and Answers	40
Annex 7:	Invitation Letters by Consultants and DC DI Khan	41
Annex 8:	List of Participants	43
Annex 9:	List of Participants	44
Annex 10:	Photo-Documentations	45
Annex 11:	Photo-Documentation of TMA Paharpur	48
Annex 12:	Photo-Documentation of TMA Parova	54

List of Tables

Table 1:	Activity Progress Overview	1
Table 2:	Targeted Tehsils	6
Table 3:	Geographical Zones and Project Clusters	7
Table 4:	Activity Progress Overview	11
Table 5:	Output A progress, until October 2024	12
Table 6:	Output B progress, until October 2024	12
Table 7:	Output C progress, until October 2024	13
Table 8:	Accessible and Inaccessible Tehsils	24

List of Figures

Figure 1:	Bannu and DI Khan Districts	7
Figure 2:	Google map indicating distance and travel time	8
Figure 3:	Project Phases	11

List of Abbreviations

AC	Assistant Commissioner
AAC	Additional Assistant Commissioner
ADC	Additional Deputy Commissioner
AD	Assistant Director
AM	Accompanying Measure
CAPEX	Capital expenditures
CSO	Civil Society Organization
DC	Deputy Commissioner
DCC	District Coordination Committee
DEWATS	Decentralised Wastewater Treatment System
DIK	Dera Ismail Khan
DPO	District Police Officer
DSP	Deputy Superintendent of Police
EPA	Environmental Protection Agency
EAD	Economic Affairs Division
ESIA	Environmental and Social Impact Assessment
ESHS	Environmental, Social and Health Safety
FGD	Focus Group Discussion
GI	Galvanized Iron
GIS	Geographic Information System
GPM	Gallons per Minute
GoKP	Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
GoP	Government of Pakistan
KfW	German Development Bank
KP	Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
LG	Local Government
LGERDD	Local Government, Elections and Rural Development Department
M&E	Monitoring & Evaluation
MIS	Management Information System
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
NC	Neighbourhood Council
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NOC	Non-Objection Certificate
OPEX	Operational expenditures
O&M	Operation and Maintenance
P&DD	Planning and Development Department
PC-I	Planning Commission Performa - I
PD	Project Director
PHED	Public Health Engineering Department
PKR	Pakistani Rupee
PM	Person Month
PMU	Project Management Unit
PRA	Participatory Rapid Appraisal
PSC	Project Steering Committee

RCC	reinforced cement concrete
RMO	Regional Monitoring Officer, KfW
RRMiC	Resilient Resource Management in Cities
RRM	Resilient Resource Management
SDO	Sub-Divisional Officer
SLF	Sanitary Landfill
SOP	Standard Operation Procedure
SWM	Solid waste management
TMA	Tehsil Municipal Administration
TMO	Tehsil Municipal Officer
TOI	Tehsil Officer Infrastructure
TOR	Terms of References
UPU	Urban Policy Unit
VC	Village Council
WAPDA	Water & Power Development Authority
WHO	World Health Organisation
WSSC	Water and Sanitation Services Company
WWTP	Wastewater Treatment Plant
X-EN	Executive Engineer

KEY DATA

Project Name	Consulting Services for Regional Infrastructure Fund for Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (RIF-II) for Resilient Resource Management in Cities
Project Region	Pakistan, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Districts D.I. Khan and Bannu
BMZ-No.	2018 68 355 KfW ID : 42975 Procurement Number 508317
Client/Project Executing Agency	Urban Planning Unit (UPU), Planning and Development Department (P&DD) of the Provincial Govern- ment of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
Financing Institution	Kreditanstalt für Wiederaufbau (KfW)
Consultant	Consortium comprising: Dorsch Impact GmbH (lead), Germany, NEC Consultants (Pvt.) Limited, Pakistan, Cynosure Consultants (Pvt). Ltd., Pakistan Sub-consultant BORDA e.V, Germany
Essential Contractual Data	
IC Contract date	17/06/2024
IC Commencement date	01/08/2024
Expected completion date	30/06/2029 (with optional extension)
Elapsed time	3 months
Amount of Consulting Contract (€)	4,321,329 €
Invoiced Amount (€)	722.507,85 €
Total Programme Funds (€)	21.000.000 €

1. Executive Summary

The reporting period of Quarterly Report No.01 covers the activities performed from August 2024 until November 2024 corresponding to logistics and activities for the Inception Phase.

Progress monitoring of tasks from this reporting period

Table 1: Activity Progress Overview

Activities	Status	Progress in %	Comment
1	Contacts with stakeholders.	Complete	100%
2	Kick-off workshop.	In progress	50%
3	Field based orientation visits with TMAs, PHED and NCs.	In progress	50%
4	Institutional assessment.	In progress	45%
5	Preparations for <i>mohalla</i> level base-line surveys.	In progress	5%
6	Pairing of experts, virtual meeting with national and international experts for physical site assessment.	In progress	10%
7	Mobilization of national experts for physical site assessment	In progress	10%
8	Drafting ToRs for hiring the civil society organization.	Complete	100%
9	Administration and logistics, office and transport etc.	In progress	45%

Activities

Project Kick-off

The Project Kick-off consist of a series of contacts with stakeholders, the Kick-off workshop and field-based orientation visits with Tehsil Municipal Administration (TMAs), Public Health Engineering Department (PHED) and Neighbourhood Council (NCs). After internal consultations and deliberations, and considering the availability of key stakeholders, it was determined that the kick-off meeting would be held on 20 August 2024. The PD¹ was consulted and confirmed his participation, subsequently issuing official invitation letters, which are attached as Annex "B" To ensure timely dissemination, most of these invitations were hand-delivered.

The list of invitees, attendees, and the meeting agenda are provided in Annexes "C" and "D," respectively. Due to various factors, including security considerations, the proceedings commenced with some delay. After an initial round of introductions, participants received a comprehensive briefing on various aspects of the RIF-II Project.

The PD provided an extensive overview of the RIF-II Project, emphasizing its role as a Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP) initiative, committed to supporting all stakeholders, line departments, and implementation partners from inception to completion. He highlighted that the primary challenge would be ensuring the timely and high-quality execution of the project within its prescribed timeline. Additionally, the essential clauses of the project's financing agreement were elucidated.

Institutional assessment

¹ Mr. Adnan Salim

To facilitate effective project implementation, the Consultant has categorized the Dera Ismail Khan (DIK) district into two clusters. Cluster 1 comprises the relatively accessible tehsils of Paharpur and Paroa, where security concerns are minimal. Conversely, Cluster 2 includes the three western tehsils Kulachi, Daraban, and Darazinda which are characterized by heightened security risks.

This assessment aims to provide the Consultants with a comprehensive understanding of the prevailing conditions in the project area. This includes evaluating community infrastructure (water supply, wastewater management, and solid waste disposal), the role of the Public Health Engineering Department (PHED) and Tehsil Municipal Administrations (TMAs) in service management, identifying existing gaps, and assessing the willingness of beneficiaries to participate in the project.

Additionally, the study seeks to assess the capacity of relevant personnel within PHED, TMAs, district administration, and the Project Management Unit (PMU)/Urban Planning Unit (UPU). A conditionality survey of the TMAs' tools and equipment—including vehicles, solid waste management trolleys, collection bins, and other machinery—will be conducted to identify deficiencies and propose appropriate mitigation measures. To achieve these objectives, a detailed questionnaire was developed and pre-tested at TMA Paharpur. Following necessary modifications, the team proceeded with the fieldwork.

Preparations for Mohalla level base-line surveys

The baseline assessment is scheduled to begin after the completion of the physical assessment. The physical assessment will survey to identify the key areas of each sectors requiring intervention across different towns. Based on these findings, the targeted population will be determined.

A sample for the baseline survey will be selected from the targeted population using a multi-stage sampling approach at the Neighbourhood Council, Tehsil, and district levels. This will ensure that data collection remains focused and efficient, engaging only with the intended population rather than the overall population. This approach will prevent unnecessary resource allocation and time loss, optimizing the survey process.

The physical assessment is planned for February, with the final report expected by March. Following this, the baseline survey design will commence in March, and data collection is scheduled for April. However, the survey will only proceed once the proposed CSO is actively involved. The CSO's role will be crucial in informing and mobilizing households before the survey begins. Additionally, their strong local presence will support data collection, facilitate smooth operations, and help address security concerns, ensuring the effectiveness of the survey.

Mobilization of national experts for physical site assessment, virtual meeting with national and international experts for physical site assessment

The Team has commenced with the pairing of local and international experts in order to carry out the physical site assessment. This assessment is planned to take place in the month of February in order to shift the analysis and most of the desk work in the month of Ramadan taking place during March. For this, the preparation of the survey creation is well underway and exchange between the waste water, solid waste management and water supply expert teams has been initiated. The survey is planned to be a mix between on site field work in the accessible areas in order to collect primary data as well as remote work and collecting of satellite and secondary data for the inaccessible project areas.

Drafting ToRs for hiring the civil society organisation

The P&DD shall contract one or two Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), particularly to support

the achievement of Output C in cooperation with the Implementation Consultant. The selected CSO(s) must be registered with the Economic Affairs Division (EAD) and hold a valid Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) from the EAD. The contracted CSO will report their work progress through the Implementation Consultant, who shall verify the progress and quality of CSO's contribution agreed in terms of references yet to be specified.

The ToRs for hiring the potential CSO are currently still being drafted

Administration and logistics, office and transport etc

DI Khan faces a chronic shortage of suitable accommodation, exacerbated by persistent security concerns over the past two decades. Despite a significant population increase and an influx of individuals from former tribal areas, modern housing developments remain absent.

The Consultant's Team encountered considerable difficulties in securing a suitable building for office and residential purposes. Efforts were made to obtain a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the military authorities to facilitate the hiring of premises within the cantonment area. However, after extensive searching, a suitable building was identified and leased in late September 2024. Following minor renovations and furnishing, the premises were occupied by the end of October 2024.

Under the RIF-II framework, plans were in place to procure two vehicles (Toyota Corolla cars) and one bulletproof SUV for the transportation of foreign visitors. However, due to the absence of the PD—the requisite procedural formalities were not completed, resulting in a delay of this procurement. This has created logistical challenges for routine travel within and beyond the project corridor.

Furthermore, the procurement of a bulletproof SUV necessitates an NOC from the federal government, a process that must be initiated by the PMU. In the interim, the Consultants have been reliant on locally hired transport services. However, given the prevailing security conditions, only trusted and vetted drivers can be engaged, further constraining mobility and operational efficiency².

Problems encountered

- The project faces several significant challenges, primarily related to security, logistical constraints, and administrative hurdles.
- Security Concerns: The region is experiencing increasing insurgency and militancy, with frequent attacks, kidnappings, and roadblocks. Limited access to tehsils restricts project activities to only 44% of the target area.
- Travel Restrictions: Militants have been conducting unauthorized spot checks, leading to abductions and security threats. Authorities have imposed travel restrictions, further limiting movement, particularly for government officials.
- Lack of Project Transport: Due to administrative delays and the absence of a Project Director (PD), the project has not been able to procure its own vehicles, relying instead on rented transport with limited trusted drivers.
- Potential Military Operations: Reports suggest a large-scale military operation may be imminent, which could lead to retaliatory attacks on civilian infrastructure, causing further instability.
- Leadership and Administrative Challenges: Frequent changes in the Project Director (PD) position have resulted in a lack of leadership and ownership, affecting coordination with the Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP) and overall project implementation. The

² Some incidents of kidnappings have been reported by travelling in the unknown and untrustworthy local transport.

changes of the PD has stalled the formation of the PMU, affecting project governance and delaying the disposition fund's operationalization.

- **Delayed Engagement of Civil Society Organizations (CSOs):** Due to leadership gaps, the hiring of a CSO has been delayed, limiting the project's ability to engage communities and conduct necessary assessments.
- **Restrictions on Foreign Visitors:** The Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP) has stopped issuing No Objection Certificates (NOCs) to foreign experts, affecting knowledge transfer and navigating the team of consultants in the right directions.

Outlook – Activities for next reporting period

- **Bannu Kick-off Workshop:** The workshop, delayed due to security concerns, is now a top priority and scheduled for January/February 2025. Advance coordination and logistical preparations will ensure timely execution when a suitable opportunity arises.
- **Institutional, Context, and Physical Assessments:** Due to security and administrative constraints, the team proceeded with Context and Institutional Assessment instead of the planned Physical Assessment. Fieldwork has commenced and is expected to conclude next quarter, followed by data compilation and report preparation.
- **Coordination with Experts:** National and international experts have been grouped by specialization and provided with relevant guidelines. Given security restrictions, international experts will guide national experts remotely. National experts may also face challenges in accessing certain areas, requiring alternative remote methodologies.
- **Hiring of a Civil Society Organization (CSO):** While government stakeholders are being engaged effectively, community involvement remains limited. The immediate hiring of a CSO is necessary to facilitate community engagement and enhance project participation.

These activities aim to mitigate delays, strengthen stakeholder collaboration, and ensure effective project implementation despite ongoing security and logistical challenges.

2. Project Background

The Regional Infrastructure Fund (RIF – II) Project was conceived under the broad umbrella of Resilient Resource Management in Cities (RRMiC). A pilot project of RRM, similar in its nature and objectives, had successfully been conducted in north-eastern part of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP) Province, Mansehra District³. Hence, it was decided that an identical project of similar nature, but with much larger dimensions, be conducted in the south-western KP. It was in this perspective that RIF – II Project is being implemented in nine tehsil towns of Bannu and Dera Ismail Khan (DI Khan).

Based on the Consultant's rich experience in Pakistan, specially based on assessment, planning and implementation of RRM Mansehra project, it has become evident, that the integration of the sectors of water supply, wastewater and solid waste management is essential for the proper functioning of the overall urban services system. Moreover, an integrated approach also means that government, stakeholders and social actors must be participants of the whole process (starting from assessment, planning, designing, implementation, until operation and maintenance). It also has to be ensured that leaders are empowered, and it also includes the vulnerable groups like women, whose capacities are strengthened and awareness raising has been done to an adequate level. For ensuring resilience and long-term sustainability, these conditionalities are inescapable requirements.

From the Consultant's perspective, Resilient Resource Management means to promote the conservation and sustainable water use to reduce water scarcity and resource depletion not only by reducing and treating wastewater, also minimizing water losses, promoting water reuse or increasing water storage, but also by increasing management, operation and maintenance efficiency by training PHED, TMAs, communities and other relevant departments. In addition, all the stakeholders have also to be educated, coached, groomed and sensitized by becoming part of these systems. Pakistan's limited drinking water sources, in general, and project corridor, in particular, are being heavily polluted by uncontrolled wastewater discharge, improper effluents handling and unsafe solid waste disposal. For this reason, the sustainable management of water resources can rarely be resolved through a single intervention or technology. It requires action at different scales and the integration of technologies in different sectors, ideally in the same spatial area. For example, by combining the construction of water supply systems and the promotion of water reuse and increase storage, with the treatment of wastewater and the reduction of solid waste to avoid water pollution could lead to a substantial reduction in the environmental, social, and economic impacts of drought in these regions, considering the current climatic scenario.

2.1. General

RIF – II Project is being implemented in two districts of south-western KP, Bannu and DI Khan. The type of potential interventions and the locations will be decided after physical site assessment and consultation with the stakeholders, including the beneficiary communities. Except headquarter tehsils, the Project interventions will be conducted in nine peripheral tehsils. Details of the targeted tehsils, along with beneficiaries' statistics, are presented in the following matrix:

³ RRM Mansehra is in the final phase of its completion, likely to get closed by end June 2025.

Table 2: Targeted Tehsils

District	Tehsil Town	Potential No of Beneficiaries
Bannu	Baka Khel	256,818
	Domel	127,256
	Kakki	82,132
	Sub-division Wazir	43,114
Subtotal Bannu:		509,320
Dera Ismail Khan	Daraban	123,933
	Darazinda	68,556
	Kulachi	101,854
	Paharpur	383,984
	Paroa	292,466
Subtotal DI Khan:		970,793
Total Potential Beneficiaries:		1,480,113

2.2. Geographical Locations and Clustering:

Headquarters of both the districts are widely apart, with a buffer zone of Lakki Marwat and Tank districts. Because of the hyper-security sensitivities, particularly in the buffer districts, there are travel restrictions. District administrations have notified that traveling is advised only in between sunrise to sunset. Unofficial curfew is imposed from sunset to sunrise⁴.

⁴ In Sep/Oct 2024, Bannu and Lakki Marwat districts police force went on strike and blocked the main Indus Highway for more than a week, which was followed by a number of protests for another 2 – 3 weeks.

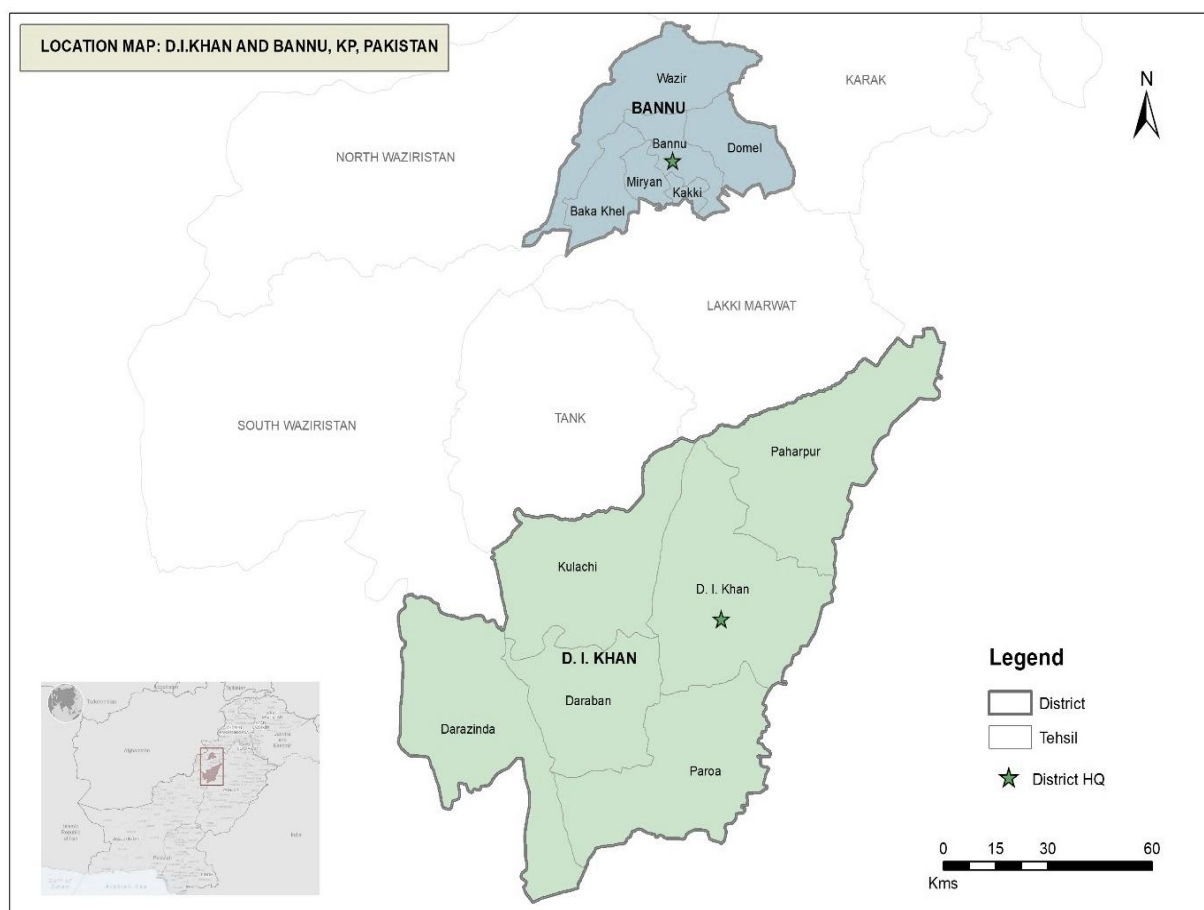


Figure 1: Bannu and DI Khan Districts

Table 3: Geographical Zones and Project Clusters

District	Cluster No.	Tehsil	NCs	VCs	Remarks
DI Khan	Cluster 1	Paharpur	4	41	
		Paroa	1	28	
	Cluster 2	Daraban	2	16	Inaccessible due to security sensitivities.
		Darazinda	1	11	
		Kulachi	6	11	
Bannu	Cluster 3a	Domel	0	14	
		Kakki	0	15	
	Cluster 3b	Baka Khel	0	13	Inaccessible due to security sensitivities.
		Sub-Division Wazir	0	6	

Because of administrative and security sensitivities, Bannu has also been sub-divided in two clusters, 3a and 3b, as indicated in the above table.

The five tehsils of DI Khan are integrated by tehsil towns and Neighbourhood Councils (NCs),

which are considered urban areas. Nevertheless, in all the four tehsils of District Bannu there are no urban areas. Hence, in this table there are only counted village councils (VCs), which represent the rural areas.

2.3. Road Commutations

During the implementation period of RIF – II Project, shuttling between Bannu and DI Khan will be a routine matter for the Consultants. Under normal traffic conditions, Bannu to DI Khan is entailing a distance of about 145 km and a travel time of 2 ¾ hours. The travel time may swell further due to high traffic density, occasional protests, temporary road blockages, terrorists' activities, road repair works and/or inclement weather conditions etc. Once the Project implementation work has commenced, a sub-office will be established at Bannu. It will be semi-independent set-up, who will be working on their own and the number of visits from the main office at DI Khan will be less frequent.

These impediments are also visible from the underneath map. However, it adds to the unidentifiable and unpredictable difficulties of Implementation Constant, entailing more than required time for completion of any task.

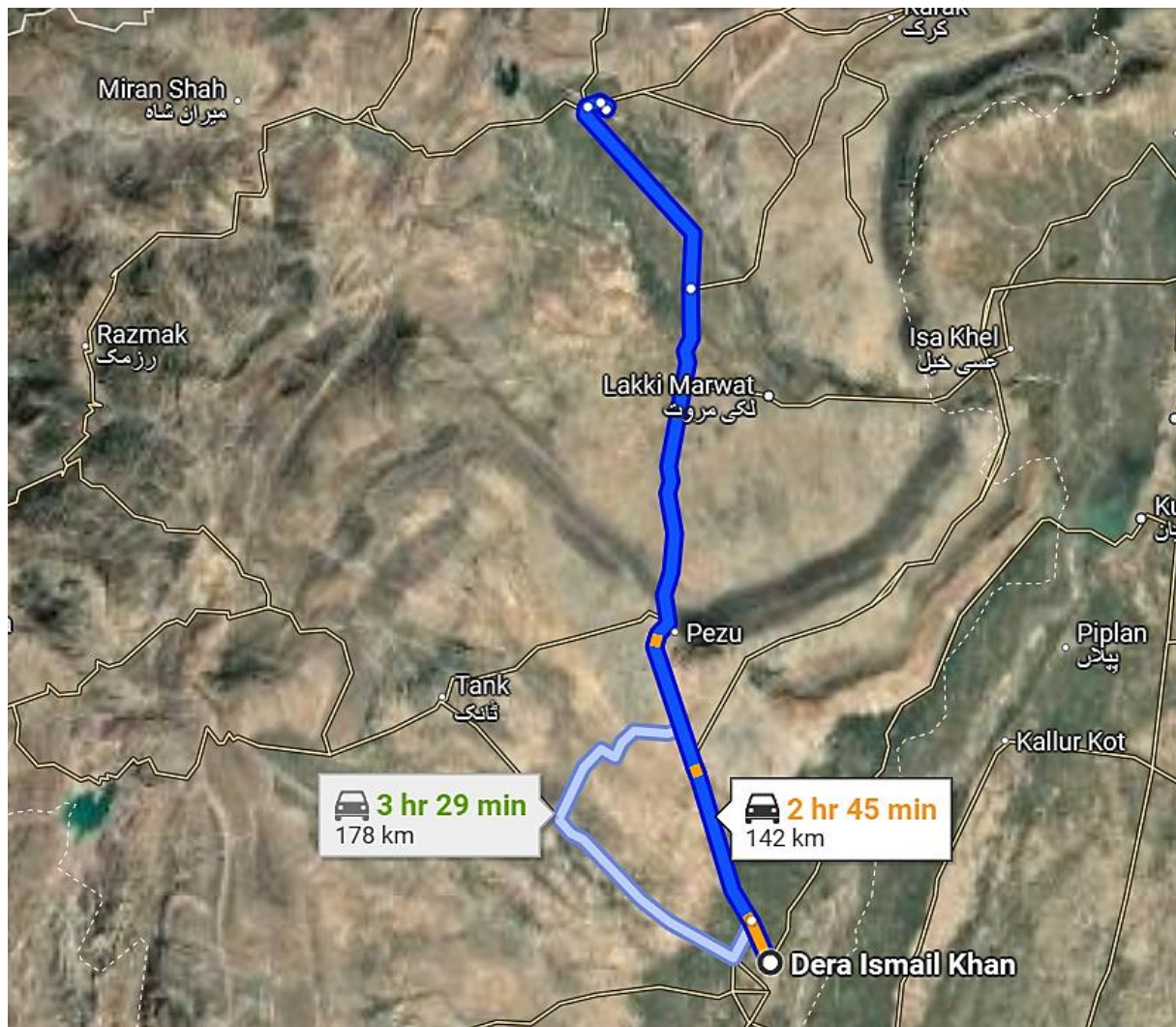


Figure 2: Map indicating distance and travel time

2.4. Methodology

This section describes the methodology proposed by the Consultant to perform their services according to the Terms of Reference (ToRs) and the envisaged Scope of Works (SW). In order

to complete this project in the allocated time, it is essential that respective tasks and activities are well planned and coordinated under a comprehensive approach and methodology at all levels to enable timely completion of the Project.

As per the TORs all selected community infrastructure schemes shall be further assessed to arrive at technical designs, Bill of Quantities, drawings, and a firm cost estimate with a realistically anticipated duration from start to completion laid down in a work plan for each selected scheme. The Implementation Consultant will supervise construction works and supplies on behalf of the Urban Policy and Planning Unit (UPU), who remains the employer of construction companies and suppliers. These tasks include the site supervision of all works, the preparation of initial operation activities, a continuous monitoring, a periodic reporting, and the participation in the preliminary acceptance.

Following methodology will be adopted for the Implementation Phase:

Out of total project duration of 72 months, the first 09 months is the inception phase. During this period, the team of implementation consultants will mainly be conducting a number of surveys and other relevant studies, which would help in need identification.

- Physical context assessment
- Institutional and stakeholder's context assessment
- Development of action plans for each tehsil
- Base-line surveys on Mohalla level
- Social assessment: conflict-sensitive approach
- Development of communication and advocacy strategy, and quick wins
- Identification and prioritization of schemes
- Definition and implementation start of social mobilization strategy
- Development of monitoring Framework
- Development ESMF

Preparation of Base Maps:

The Consultant will create maps at various scales to document and analyse the complexity of existing conditions. These maps will help identify problems, hotspots, and opportunities for infrastructure implementation and future technical solutions. Initial mapping will focus on Tehsil towns, capturing general areas, town and neighbourhood structures, and natural resource patterns (e.g., rivers, springs). The process will begin with an overview of water supply, wastewater, and solid waste management infrastructure, gradually adding detail through assessments and mapping workshops. The maps will integrate with P&DD and UPU GIS databases, complement District Masterplans, and serve as a foundation for managing and monitoring infrastructure. They will also aid climate-resilient planning by identifying current infrastructure, potential sites for new schemes, and flood-risk areas to support Climate-Informed Urban Planning.

Baseline Surveys:

An integrated baseline survey is planned to gather essential baseline data aligned with project indicators and provide context-specific details for developing detailed designs. This survey will establish pre-project scenarios for each indicator and set benchmarks for measuring project effects and outcomes. The survey will use mixed methods to collect qualitative and quantitative data via household surveys conducted with a semi-structured online questionnaire created in KoBo Toolbox. Data will be gathered using tables for efficient field collection and centralized database analysis. Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) tools may also be employed for sectors like solid waste, wastewater, and water supply management. Enumerators, team supervisors,

and support staff will receive training, and questionnaires will be field-tested to refine methods for administering Focus Group Discussions (FGDs). The survey will also include questions to inform awareness-raising activities, collecting baseline data on behaviors in pilot areas to design tailored campaigns for behavior change.

Community Participation:

The consultant will collaborate with relevant departments and NC/VC representatives to organize and communicate with households. A community activist from each project area will act as a local resource person, supporting social mobilization teams alongside NC/VC representatives. Two local female social mobilization experts will ensure access to households and coordinate surveys. NC/VC representatives will be trained in survey methodology and field plans, contributing to their capacity-building efforts.

The beneficiary communities are residing within TMAs, NCs and, at times, even within VCs. Being an urban development project, the main developmental interventions will be in urban towns or peri-urban areas, i.e. within the jurisdictions of TMAs. Generally, a TMA may be subdivided into smaller units, i.e. NCs. Some of the NCs may also be having a peri-urban character, also having some VCs, which are rural communities. A mohalla may comprise upon a few compact streets within an urban area. In a traditional societal character, a mohalla may often contain a close-knit community of one clan or sub-clan, who are directly or indirectly linked with each other due to cross marriages.

3. RIF II Result Matrix

RIF – II is passing through the identification and inception phase, which has a time budget of nine months. All other follow-up activities will be undertaken after the completion of inception of this phase. The Figure below outlines the three main project phases.

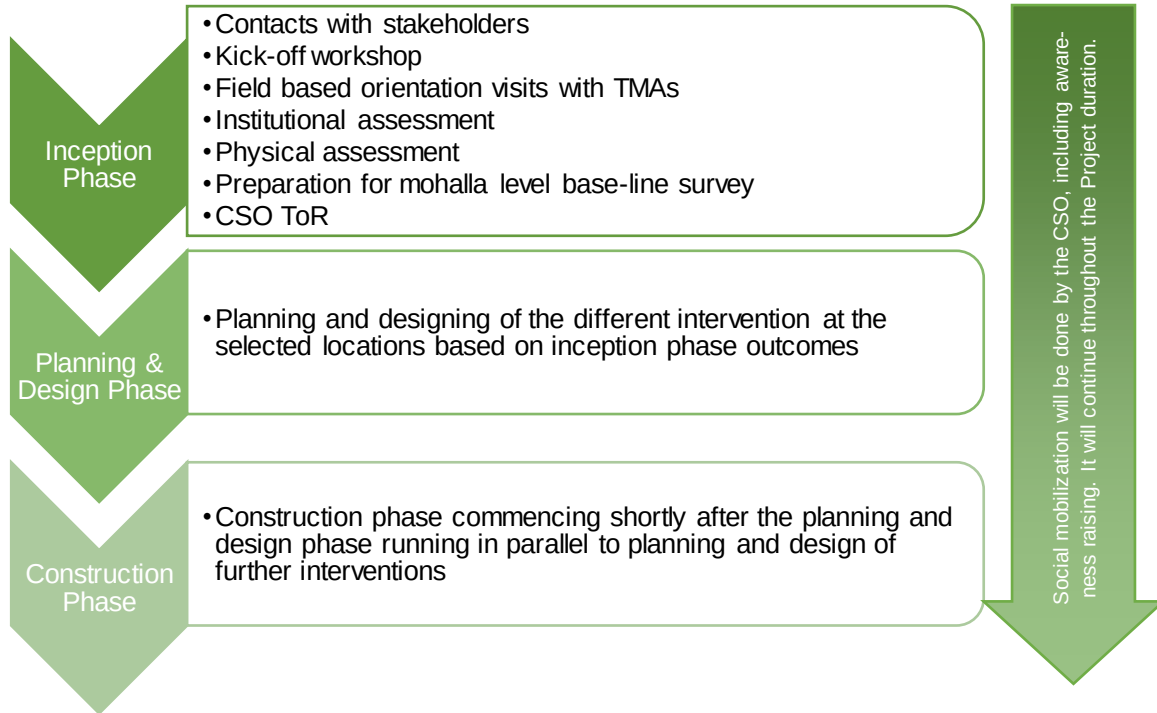


Figure 3: Project Phases

3.1. Overall Output Progress

The overall progress, in terms of percentage (%), for the reported period is being presented in the following matrix:

Table 4: Activity Progress Overview

	Activity Description	Progress %	Remarks
1	Contacts with stakeholders.	100%	
2	Kick-off workshop.	50%	
3	Field based orientation visits with TMAs, PHED and NCs.	50%	
4	Institutional assessment.	45%	Bannu is pending due to security reasons.
5	Preparations for <i>mohalla</i> level base-line surveys.	5%	
6	Pairing of experts, virtual meeting with national and international experts for physical site assessment.	10%	
7	Mobilization of national experts for physical site assessment	10%	
8	Drafting ToRs for hiring the civil society organisation.	100%	
9	Administration and logistics, office and transport etc.	45%	

3.2. Activity Matrix

3.2.1. Activity A Progress

Table 5: Output A progress, until October 2024

Output	Indicator	Assessment
Output A <i>Showcase community infrastructure addressing water supply, affluent and solid waste have been identified, designed, and built.</i>	Indicator: The access of households to community infrastructure has improved. Baseline value: 0 (to be confirmed at inception) Target value: at least one sector project in each selected tehsil town <u>For annual reporting:</u> Current value ¹ : Achievable during project duration ¹ : yes/no	- Project baseline assessment at inception. - Data and statistics of Tehsil towns. - Planning and approval documents from the provincial Annual Development Plans. - Project progress reviews. - Interviews with households.
Activity		Progress%
Activity-A	Select, design, and build schemes for Tehsil towns in D.I. Khan and Bannu districts.	
1.1	Carry out relevant situation analysis and baseline studies for the Tehsil towns concerning available facilities and resources regarding water supply and the management of affluent (sanitation) and solid waste through the Implementation Consultant assigned to the project.	8%
1.2	Conduct the mapping of each Tehsil town showing water sources and potential land for wastewater treatment and landfill sites for solid waste management and waste recycling.	0%
1.3	Rehabilitate and complete selected drainage systems to allow for water treatment	0%
1.4	Rehabilitate selected surface water treatment plants with a special emphasis on appropriate process technologies and protection from solid waste and other pollution.	0%
1.5	Identify the potential for improving selected facilities or suggest replacing facilities regarding water supply/discharge/treatment and solid waste management.	0%
1.6	Develop and assess the availability of water sources (spring, surface, groundwater) for sustainable utilization through appropriate technologies in combination with recommendations to preserve natural resources.	0%
1.7	Promote the separation of solid waste at a household level, waste collection, waste treatment (recycling by manual sorting), composting, and the sanitary landfill (deposition of rejects and residual waste).	0%

3.2.2. Activity Progress Output B

Table 6: Output B progress, until October 2024

Output	Indicator	Assessment
Output B <i>Relevant staff of concerned departments at provincial, district and tehsil level have been supported to increase their capacity (resources and competence) for integrated and coordinated planning.</i>	Indicator: Newly acquired knowhow is applied in department's work. Hiring of dedicated roles and functions to support project objectives. Baseline value: 0 (to be confirmed at inception) Target value: (to be confirmed at inception) <u>For annual reporting:</u> Current value ¹ :	Tbd

	Achievable during project duration ¹ : yes/no	
<i>Activity</i>		<i>Pro- gress%</i>
Activity B	Relevant staff of concerned departments at the provincial, district, and tehsil level have been supported to increase their capacity (resources and competence) for integrated and coordinated planning.	0%
2.1	Support the UPU of KP in the realization of selected results from the Master Planning for Bannu and DI Khan	0%
2.2	Develop practise-oriented skills development schemes regarding water and solid waste management	0%
2.3	Advise on the purchase of equipment feasible to address water and solid waste management in Tehsil towns of Bannu and D.I. Khan	0%
2.4	Develop training material and practical trainings on environment protection	0%

3.2.3. Activity Progress Output C

Table 7: Output C progress, until October 2024

Output	Indicator	Assessment
<i>Output C</i> <i>Citizen-state dialogue formats have been initiated to offer opportunities for citizen participation in selection, realization, and maintenance of community infrastructure schemes.</i>	Indicator: Community participation events have taken place. Baseline value: 0 Target value: 10 <u>For annual reporting:</u> Current value 1: Achievable during project duration ¹ : yes/no	- Community development plans - Documentation of events - Project progress review - Interviews with households
<i>Activity</i>		<i>Pro- gress%</i>
Activity C	<i>Initiate citizen-state dialogue and promote citizen participation</i>	0%
3.1	Identify legitimized community representatives reflecting the Tehsil town's composition in terms of social strata, age, and gender.	0%
3.2	Facilitate the involvement of identified community representatives in scheme selection (Activity A).	0%
3.3	Identify community contributions with the community representatives for the realization and maintenance of schemes supported by the project (Activity A).	0%
3.4	Train the communities in sustainable utilization of community infrastructure, natural resources, and the handling of waste.	0%
3.5	Identify additional efforts of the Tehsil towns by the Implementation Consultant and finance through the project.	0%

4. Project Implementation

4.1. Project Inception Phase

The implementation of the RIF-II Project commenced on 1 August 2024 in the designated districts. As planned, the initiation took place in Dera Ismail Khan (DIK), which is also designated as the location for the main project office.

The primary objective of the Consultant during the initial phase was to establish direct engagement with key stakeholders, providing a brief introduction to the project and the available members of the implementation team. In this context, the Project Director (PD) of RIF-II was requested to issue introductory letters to all relevant stakeholders, which he graciously facilitated. A copy of this letter is attached as Annex – “A”.

Within the initial few days, Consultants made a courtesy call on the following officials of the district and regional administration:

- Deputy Commissioner (DC).
- District Police Officer (DPO).
- Assistant Director (AD) Local Government, Elections and Rural Development Department (LGE&RDD).
- Regional Municipality Officer (RMO) LGE&RDD.
- Tehsil Municipal Officers (TMO), TMAs.
- Public Health and Engineering Department (PHED).
- Water Supply and Sewerage Company (WSSC).

In addition, the Consultants also met with the other development workers and other organizations, operating within DIK region, in general, and project corridor, in particular:

The team got a positive response and welcome gestures from all concerned, assuring for their outright cooperation and full support. In view of the oscillating security situation within the project corridor, efforts had also been made to establish contacts with the local army authorities.

During interactions with stakeholders, the team also provided preliminary information regarding the forthcoming kick-off meeting, which would formally introduce the project through a structured briefing session.

Proposed outputs to be integral part of the Inception Report:

- **Context assessment report:** containing the analysis of the technical data collection, current situation, problematic, potential areas of intervention and list of priority schemes.
- **Institutional and social assessment report:** containing the analysis of the stakeholder's data to define social mobilization strategies, capacity development needs, documentation of current available equipment and resources to take into consideration for the design of measures, identification of focal persons, identification and assessment of risks for definition of mitigation measures, etc.
- **Situation maps** for all the nine tehsils.
- **Baseline report:** containing the results from the household surveys for the definition of benchmarks to measure the project objectives and indicators. Second, the analysis of the current household and community behaviour to address during awareness raising activities/ campaign, and lastly, additional technical data on water supply, wastewater management and solid waste management necessary for the selection of schemes, and the planning of technical studies and designs – once selected and approved.

4.2. Kick-off Workshop

After internal team consultations and due deliberations, as well as the availability status of key stakeholders, it was decided that kick-off meeting will be held on 20 August 2024. The PD was also taken on board, who confirmed his availability and consented for the same schedule. He was also kind to write the invitation letters, which is attached as Annex – “B”. For ensuring on-time delivery, almost all the invitation letters were delivered by hand.

The list of invitees, attendees and planned schedule of meeting are attached as Annex – “C”, and Annex – “D”, respectively.

Due to various contributing factors, including the dominant aspect of security, the proceedings took a delayed start. After a brief introduction of all the participants, the audience were briefed about various features of RIF – II Project.

The PD provided an extensive overview of the RIF-II Project, emphasizing its role as a Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP) initiative, committed to supporting all stakeholders, line departments, and implementation partners from inception to completion. He highlighted that the primary challenge would be ensuring the timely and high-quality execution of the project within its prescribed timeline. Additionally, the essential clauses of the project's financing agreement were elucidated.

Key aspects of the project discussed in detail included:

- Project area demographics, including population and household statistics.
- Geographical scope of the project, encompassing nine tehsils across the two target districts.
- Current status and capacity limitations of Tehsil Municipal Administrations (TMAs) and gaps in municipal service coverage.
- Proposed interventions under RIF-II and its various components.
- Implementation strategy.
- Structure and composition of the Project Steering Committee (PSC) at the provincial level.
- Structure and composition of the District Coordination Committee (DCC) for each district.
- Organizational framework of the Project Management Unit (PMU).

Following the PD's presentation, the implementation team provided an overview of:

- The objectives of RIF-II, its three key outputs, and corresponding indicators for measuring project success.
- The various project phases spanning six years (72 months), each detailed accordingly
- The geographical coverage of the project, including tehsil-wise population statistics.
- Supporting documentation, including two brief audio-visual clips from the pilot phase of RRM Mansehra, presented for reference.

The briefing was delivered through a PowerPoint presentation, which was received with keen interest by the attendees. Selected photographs from the kick-off workshop are attached as Annex – “E”.

A question-and-answer session followed, where participants expressed high levels of engagement by raising various queries. These were addressed by the PD and the implementation team. The details of this discussion are presented in Annex – “F”.

4.3. Briefing for Tehsils Administration

Due to security-related complexities and other commitments, a majority of tehsil-based civil, police, and TMA officials could not attend the kick-off meeting on 20 August 2024. Recognizing the significance of their role in project implementation, it was deemed necessary to bridge this gap before field activities commenced. Accordingly, the DC was informed and requested to convene a meeting at their office premises.

The DC responded positively and issued a formal request for attendance to the respective officials of all five tehsils. By mutual agreement, the meeting was scheduled for 12 September 2024, coinciding with the routine monthly meeting of all Assistant Commissioners (ACs). The DC's letter is attached as Annex "G".

Owing to the DC's presence, a significant number of invited officials were in attendance. The list of participants is provided in Annex "H". The meeting, chaired by the DC, commenced with a brief introduction to the RIF-II Project, emphasizing its importance and potential benefits to the five tehsils of DI Khan.

The implementation team delivered a structured presentation covering:

- Overall project objectives and their alignment with sustainable development goals.
- A general description of the project's geographical coverage, including demographic data.
- Project landscape, executing agency, financing structure, and implementation consultants.
- Introduction of implementing partners within the Consultant consortium.
- Roles and responsibilities of line departments and key stakeholders.
- Overview of the RIF-II result matrix, including objectives, outputs, and output indicators.
- Governance structures, including the PSC and DCC at respective levels.
- Structure and functions of the PMU.
- A visual and video preview of RRM Mansehra as a case study.
- Implementation strategy, covering phases of inception, planning, design, execution, and operations & maintenance (O&M).
- Area division into clusters for effective implementation.
- Monitoring and evaluation mechanisms, including online MIS and result-based reporting.
- Next steps in a stepwise cascading approach towards project completion.

Following the presentation, an interactive session was conducted, where participants sought clarifications and raised concerns, which were duly addressed by the Consultants. The detailed proceedings of this session are documented in questionnaire format in Annex "I," with selected photographs presented in Annex – "J".

4.4. Educational Visit to RRM Mansehra

Subsequent to project commencement, an educational and orientation visit of RIF – II team was conducted to RRM Mansehra. The RRM team provided them a comprehensive briefing and facilitated field visits to selected project sites. The RIF-II team, in their capacity as apprentices, benefited from practical, on-the-job training⁵.

4.5. Field Visits

Following the successful completion of the kick-off meeting, the team initiated field visits to two

⁵ The RIF – II team comprised upon Ayaz Khan (Team Leader), Nasrullah Khan (Coordinator) and Hamdan Bangash (Accounts Manager).

accessible tehsils, Paharpur and Parova. The objective was to gain firsthand insights, engage with TMA staff and tehsil administration, observe the feasibility of proposed interventions, and assess the prevailing security conditions concerning project activities.

The detailed findings from the visits to Paharpur and Parova, including security assessments, infrastructure conditions, and stakeholder interactions, are documented in subsequent sections. Relevant visual documentation is attached as Annexes "K" and "L."

4.6. Stakeholders Contacts – Preliminary Feedback

The implementation team established formal and informal interactions with key stakeholders, leading to a preliminary institutional assessment, which is subject to further refinement through continued engagement. The responses from district administration, PHED, TMAs, and WSSC, as well as their respective capacities, challenges, and commitments, have been documented in this section.

4.6.1. District Administration

The district and tehsil administrations have promised for their outright cooperation and facilitation in RIF – II implementation, in letter and spirit. They have the capacity and will to uphold their words. Prior to her current portfolio as DC DIK⁶, she had been dealing with the foreign funded projects at civil secretariat Peshawar. Hence, she is well aware about RIF – II and its working dynamics. She has already appointed her principal staff officer as the focal person for RIF – II. The Consultants are maintaining a cordial relationship with her office.

The team received an equally good and encouraging response from the DPO. Their tehsil-based DSPs have already been briefed about the Project and they have displayed very positive response.

4.6.2. Public Health Engineering Department

PHED is a well-organized body of professionals, who are responsible for providing drinking water supply to rural populace. In view of capacity limitations of TMAs, they also help them out in implementation of drinking water supply projects as a deposit work. Upon completion, the same are handed over to TMAs for routine O&M activities.

At divisional level of DI Khan, PHED is headed by a superintending engineer (SE), who is the technical head for the department. Whereas, at district level of DI Khan, the department is headed by the executive engineer (XEN), who is supported with sub-divisional officers (SDOs) and sub-engineers, responsible for tehsils.

They are maintaining a reasonably well-equipped laboratory for routine water testing at divisional level. At the same time, they also have a team of qualified surveyors and equipment for topographic surveys. PHED displayed an exceptionally good participation in the kick-off meeting.

Despite their professional working, PHED invariably continues to overlook the safe disposal of waste-water. This aspect of paramount importance has either been not addressed at planning and designing stage or has been omitted at the implementation stage. The same holds true for burial of water supply pipe lines.

4.6.3. Tehsil Municipal Administration (TMA)

TMAs are the direct and principal beneficiaries of RIF – II Project. Their capacity limitations have been noted at every step. There is an alarming lack of will to learn and to improve. It starts from the office discipline. Most of their offices are thinly attended, absence is without any

⁶ Mrs. Sarah Rehman is the Deputy Commissioner DI Khan.

justifiable reasons. TMAs' ship is sailing without rudders. There is almost no culture of checks and balances.

A testimonial of this statement is that, despite invitation for the kick-off meeting, their presence was very lean and thin. The team visited two TMAs, left their contacts and explained their objectives, no one ever contacted back.

4.6.4. Water and Sanitation Services Company (WSSC)

WSSC DIK was established in 2016 – 17. It is a public sector company established by GoKP under Company Ordinance 1984. As per its basic mandate, WSSC is responsible for the provision of quality water supply, sanitation and solid waste management services to half a million urban residents of the DI Khan city. The PHED is responsible for the provision of water supply and sanitation services in rural areas, beyond the access of TMAs.

Since the establishment the WSSC has no technical staff, lack of machinery and no organogram. They have complained about their multiple limitations, hampering their operational performance. Recently, USAID provided advanced machinery, including compactors and suction machines, to improve the operational capacity of WSSC. However, by virtue of their under-capabilities, they cannot use this equipment in an effective manner.

They insisted that, being the largest city in the division, RIF – II must also work in urban limits of DIK city. The Consultants advised them for referring the matter to P&D Department, GoKP.

4.7. TORs for Civil Society Organization

The P&DD shall contract one or two Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), particularly to support the achievement of Output C in cooperation with the Implementation Consultant. The selected CSO(s) must be registered with the Economic Affairs Division (EAD) and hold a valid Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) from the EAD. The contracted CSO will report their work progress through the Implementation Consultant, who shall verify the progress and quality of CSO's contribution agreed in terms of references yet to be specified.

The ToRs for hiring the potential CSO are currently still being drafted.

4.8. Context and Institutional Assessment

To facilitate effective project implementation, the Consultants have categorized the Dera Ismail Khan (DIK) district into two clusters. Cluster 1 comprises the relatively accessible tehsils of Paharpur and Paroa, where security concerns are minimal. Conversely, Cluster 2 includes the three western tehsils—Kulachi, Daraban, and Darazinda—which are characterized by heightened security risks.

This assessment aims to provide the Consultants with a comprehensive understanding of the prevailing conditions in the project area. This includes evaluating community infrastructure (water supply, wastewater management, and solid waste disposal), the role of the Public Health Engineering Department (PHED) and Tehsil Municipal Administrations (TMAs) in service management, identifying existing gaps, and assessing the willingness of beneficiaries to participate in the project.

Additionally, the study seeks to assess the capacity of relevant personnel within PHED, TMAs, district administration, and the Project Management Unit (PMU)/Urban Planning Unit (UPU). A conditionality survey of the TMAs' tools and equipment—including vehicles, solid waste management trolleys, collection bins, and other machinery—will be conducted to identify deficiencies and propose appropriate mitigation measures. To achieve these objectives, a detailed questionnaire was developed and pre-tested at TMA Paharpur. Following necessary modifications, the team proceeded with the fieldwork.

4.8.1. Cluster – 1

Cluster 1 encompasses the tehsils of Paharpur and Paroa, which are more accessible and present fewer security challenges. The assessment commenced at TMA Paharpur, where the majority of technical staff were available and demonstrated a high degree of cooperation. The team engaged extensively with various officials and their support staff, supplemented by field visits to selected sites.

4.8.2. Cluster – 2

Cluster 2 consists of the three western tehsils of Kulachi, Daraban, and Darazinda. Due to the volatile security situation, including recent incidents of kidnapping for ransom, armed robbery, and homicide, physical visits to these areas were deemed unfeasible. The district administration also advised against travel to these locations, citing security risks. It was further observed that administrative officials—including civil, police, revenue, and TMA personnel—were also conducting their operations remotely from DIK. Given these constraints, alternative methodologies for data collection were explored. The team sought the assistance of the Regional Monitoring Officer (RMO), who offered both facilitation and the use of his office for conducting assessments⁷. It was suggested that senior TMA officials be interviewed at the RMO's premises. Field data collection was delegated to junior TMA staff stationed in their respective tehsils. To ensure consistency, the Consultants developed Urdu-language questionnaires and provided training to these enumerators. All three TMAs were informed in advance regarding the schedule and venue of the meetings at the RMO's office. Each TMA was allocated a full day for the assessment; however, absenteeism among officials led to significant delays, extending the process by several days. Similar challenges were encountered in gathering field data, further prolonging the assessment period.

This remote-working methodology presented various challenges, advantages, and limitations. Although the Consultants initially anticipated completing the assessment within three days, the process ultimately extended beyond a week.

4.9. Administration and Logistics

4.9.1. Hiring Office Building

DI Khan faces a chronic shortage of suitable accommodation, exacerbated by persistent security concerns over the past two decades. Despite a significant population increase and an influx of individuals from former tribal areas, modern housing developments remain absent.

The Consultant's Team encountered considerable difficulties in securing a suitable building for office and residential purposes. Efforts were made to obtain a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the military authorities to facilitate the hiring of premises within the cantonment area. However, after extensive searching, a suitable building was identified and leased in late September 2024. Following minor renovations and furnishing, the premises were occupied by the end of October 2024.

4.9.2. Project Transport

Under the RIF-II framework, plans were in place to procure two vehicles (Toyota Corolla cars) and one bulletproof SUV for the transportation of foreign visitors. However, due to the absence of the PD—the requisite procedural formalities were not completed, resulting in a delay of this procurement. This has created logistical challenges for routine travel within and beyond the project corridor.

⁷ RMO is the technical supervisor of all TMAs in DI Khan division, comprising upon three districts of DI Khan, Tank and South Waziristan. TMAs are reporting to RMO, who in turn reports to Local Council Board.

Furthermore, the procurement of a bulletproof SUV necessitates an NOC from the federal government, a process that must be initiated by the PMU. In the interim, the Consultants have been reliant on locally hired transport services. However, given the prevailing security conditions, only trusted and vetted drivers can be engaged, further constraining mobility and operational efficiency⁸.

⁸ Some incidents of kidnappings have been reported by travelling in the unknown and untrustworthy local transport.

5. Financial Information

5.1. Consultancy Budget

Description	Invoice Number	Date of Invoice	Date of Payment	Total payment received EUR 31.12.2024
Quarterly payments				
Advance payment	7.01.4948 / 1	30.10.2024	27.11.2024	648 199.35
Quarterly instalment	7.01.4948 / 2	27.11.2024	03.12.2024	74 308.50
Total Lump sum payments				
Reimbursable payments				
None yet				
Total Reimbursable payments				
Reimbursable (still open)				

5.2. Reimbursables

No reimbursables have been invoiced so far

Summary of Expenses - Reimbursable (February 2021 - Sep 2024) Invoiced to KfW					
Budget line	Description	Original Budget EUR	Budget Spent in PKR	Budget Spent in EUR	Balance EUR
None yet					
Total					

5.3. Disposition Fund

The Disposition Fund as of 30.09.2024 is no active yet due to the delays with the PD and PMU.

	Total Budget	Budget (EUR)	Expenditures (EUR)	Remaining (EUR)

5.4. Procurement

No procurement has been executed

Summary of Disbursements (February 2021 - Sep 2024) Invoiced to KfW					
Budget line	Description	Original Budget EUR	Budget Spent in PKR	Budget Spent in EUR	Balance EUR
None yet					
Total					

6. ESHS Performance

Due to a number of constraints, impediments, hurdles and other difficulties, no progress has been made on this important aspect of Environmental, Social, Health and Safety (ESHS). As per inception phase work plan, this activity will be undertaken after having completed the physical assessment and identification and prioritization of schemes.

However, the consultants of this field are being contacted for mobilization so that they can orientate themselves with the project corridor and its eco-system, which is a pre-requisite.

7. Quality Management

The Consultants and their partners are conscious of applying a process-oriented quality management system characterized by standardized processes, that will serve as a universal guide throughout all project phases, ensuring the delivery of results and outcomes as outlined in the Technical Proposal. Additionally, it provides appropriate home office support and backstopping while addressing emerging challenges in a timely, professional, and suitable manner.

We consider the performance of our experts, transparent information flow, efficient utilization of the project budget, and adequate security measures as critical factors for the successful Project implementation.

However, quality management aspects are more relevant to the design and physical implementation stage of the Project. Hence, as yet not much has been contributed to quality management.

8. Challenges

8.1. Security

The overall security situation in both districts has shown a concerning trend, primarily due to insurgency and militancy. Kidnappings for ransom remain a prevalent issue. In recent months, militant activities have expanded towards urban centers, exhibiting early signs of urban guerrilla warfare. In response, district authorities have advised officials to avoid using government-registered license plates on their vehicles. Instead, official vehicles are required to display private registration plates, and officers have been instructed not to carry their identification cards. During the reporting period, the following security-related incidents have been observed

- Police strikes in Bannu and Lakki Marwat districts.
- Militant attacks on Bannu police lines, followed by widespread protests and city-wide lock-downs.
- Sudden and impromptu roadblocks along the Bannu–Dera Ismail Khan highway.
- Militant attacks on the Frontier Corps fort in Darazinda.
- Ongoing military operations, particularly in Bakka Khel and Sub-Division Wazir.

In Bannu, only two out of four tehsils are accessible, allowing the project to operate in just 50% of the district. Similarly, in Dera Ismail Khan, only two out of five tehsils are accessible, restricting project activities to 40% of the district. Overall, the project can only operate in 44% of the targeted area across both districts, while the remaining 56% remains inaccessible.

Table 8: Accessible and Inaccessible Tehsils

District	Accessible	Inaccessible
Bannu	Domel	Baka Khel
	Kakki	Sub-division Wazir
Dera Ismail Khan	Paharpur	Daraban
	Paroa	Darazinda
		Kulachi
Total:	04	05

8.2. Road Travel Conditions

A number of instances have been reported on the Islamabad – DI Khan motorway (N-14), where insurgents have conducted unauthorized spot checks on private vehicles, public transport, and passenger buses. Multiple cases of abductions and kidnappings have been recorded. In light of these developments, regional authorities have issued advisories urging travellers to avoid a 100-kilometer stretch of the motorway passing through Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. A dusk-to-dawn travel restriction has been imposed, particularly for government officials. As an alternative, travellers must use the longer and more time-consuming route via Paharpur, Chashma Barrage, Mianwali, and Daud Khel to connect to the motorway. These travel conditions have further restricted the movement of the implementation team.

Followings had been the most common targets of the militants:

- Security agencies, including police and para-military.
- In recent days, even the security persons coming home on leave have also been attacked and killed.
- Government officials and employees of any category.

- Foreigners, irrespective of their nationality.
- Workers of foreign funded projects, development workers and NGOs staff.
- Non-local residents.

Due to administrative delays and the absence of a designated Project Director (PD), the project has not yet been able to procure its own vehicles. Currently, the team relies on rented transport, operated by a limited number of trusted drivers. This dependency poses logistical and security-related challenges, particularly in high-risk areas.

8.3. Potential Military Operations

There have been ongoing discussions about a large-scale military operation in the region. Civilian unrest has also been reported, largely due to prevailing uncertainty, fear, and political instability following the general elections of February 2024. This unrest has been further exploited by militant groups, who have increased both the frequency and severity of their attacks.

If a military operation is launched, experience suggests that militant retaliation is likely. Historically, insurgents have targeted soft civilian locations, such as schools, hospitals, bus stops, and other areas of mass congregation.

8.4. Project Leadership and Administration

The Rural Infrastructure Fund (RIF-II) Project has faced leadership challenges due to frequent changes in the Project Director (PD) position.

As a result, the project has lacked both leadership and ownership, operating without a structured connection to the Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP). The absence of a PD has significantly hindered coordination and decision-making processes⁹.

Due to the lack of a designated PD, the PMU has not been formally established. Consequently, there is no dedicated structure to guide and facilitate project implementation in alignment with its objectives. A similar delay has been observed in operationalizing the disposition fund, further affecting project activities.

8.5. Engagement of CSO

The absence of a PD has also delayed the hiring of a Civil Society Organization (CSO), which should have been onboard from the project's inception. The CSO's engagement is crucial for activities such as institutional and physical assessments, community mobilization, and project selection. The drafting of the ToR for the CSO are now in progress and under revision with the Consultant's Team.

8.6. Restrictions on Foreign Visitors

Since September/October 2024, the Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (GoKP) has not issued No Objection Certificates (NOCs) to foreign visitors. Unofficial sources suggest that this restriction is due to rising militancy and security concerns.

As the project is donor-funded by KfW, this restriction has become a major obstacle. Several international experts, whose contributions could have been valuable, are unable to visit the project area. The lead consultants, being a German firm, are also unable to conduct on-ground assessments. Although virtual meetings are being used as an interim solution, they cannot

⁹ Mr. Adnan Salim was the first PD, followed by Mr. Adnan Faridi. Both were appointed on an additional charge basis. Mr. Muhammad Saleh was appointed towards end January 2025 as a full time PD.

fully substitute for in-person engagements.

8.7. Political Influences

DI Khan is currently one of the most politically volatile districts in Pakistan. The region is home to both the Governor of KP and the Chief Minister, who belong to opposing political parties. Additionally, another influential political figure from a prominent politico-religious faction resides in the district¹⁰. This political landscape has resulted in a deeply divided society, with various factions frequently engaging in confrontations, sometimes involving armed conflict. During field visits, the project team has encountered politically charged groups. In certain instances, the team had to clarify project objectives to avoid political interference. Given the political climate, multiple factions seek to associate themselves with the project for political gain, making it challenging to maintain neutrality.

¹⁰ Maulana Fazal-ur-Rehman of JUI (Jamiat-e-Ulema of Islam) Party, a religious-political party.

9. Risk Assessment and Prospect of Achieving the Overall Project Goals

A revised and updated risk assessment matrix, displaying the basic ranking at the time of bidding and the current status as per ground realities, is presented below. It also gives a brief explanation for the post-mitigation scenario.

Event	Risk Ranking		Mitigation Measures	Risk after Mitigation	Remarks
	Original	Current			
Denied access to specific Project locations due to security reasons.	High	Very High	- Constant vigilance. - Close liaison with civil/military officials, RMO, and on-site tehsil administration. - Processing all the legal required documentation (NOC) proactively prior to site visits.	Very High	During recent times, security has gone from bad to worst. Exodus of locals has increased. No immediate signs of any settlements.
Kidnap for ransom or political purposes.	Medium	Very High	- Secure accommodation and office. - Site- specific security assessment. - Presence of security guards. - Avoiding night travel. - Proactive communication with stakeholders and administration officials.	Very High	Kidnappings for ransom have drastically increased. Cases have been reported in the broad day-light from motorway section within the KP. Perhaps, it has become the major source of funds generation by the militants.
Improvised explosive device (IED) near to travel route or workplace, either vehicle borne or planted.	High	Very High	- Secure accommodation and office. - Usage of security equipment, razor wire fence and CCTV system. - Expats must use armoured vehicles and escort. - Adhering to district police and RMO's advice	Very High	Increased insurgency has proportionately brought a higher surge in IEDs cases, resulting in considerable number of damages and deaths.
Sectarian violence and tribal dispute	High	High	- Proactive site assessment. - Communication with local authorities and community people. - Avoid areas of dispute. - Stay neutral during community meetings.	Medium	In DI Khan three tehsils are known for a varying degree of sectarian violence, i.e. DI Khan, Paharpur and Parova. <i>Shia – Sunni</i> rift is a simmering issue for the past nearly three decades.

			• Avoid political and religious discussions. • Secure accommodation and office.		
Small firearms.	Medium	Medium	• Secure accommodation and office. • Armoured vehicles for expats.	Medium	Pathan population is known for being trigger happy. Firing is also done at occasions of happiness, like marriages. At occasions, stray bullets have also caused deaths.
Thefts.	Medium	Medium	• Secure accommodation and office. • Adhering to district police. • RMO advice.	Medium	DI Khan has become an undedared IDPs camp. Theft cases have increased due to new in-migrants from unsettled areas of militancy.
Natural disasters – flash rain storms and subsequent floodings and landslides, wind/dust storms, and earthquakes, etc.	Medium	Medium	• Check forecasts from Pakistan Meteorological Department and the National Disaster Management Authority website. • Stay indoor during wind storms. • Check news reports. • Be aware of the risk of road blockages, particularly in mountainous regions.	Medium	Project corridor is located in sub-tropical sandy desert, Thal, which is known for ferocious summer wind storms. It may cause severe damages.
COVID-19 & Infections; in- jury or disease from environ- mental contamination	Low	Medium	• Personal hygiene. • All the precautionary measures. • Wearing face masks all the time. • Social distancing. • Washing hands, using hand sanitizers etc. • In case of doubts, COVID-19 infection tests. • Vaccinations.	Medium	Due to poor sanitation, there are a lot of water ponds. Hence, reemergence of COVID-19 infection, malaria and/or dengue fever cannot be ruled out.

10. Outlook and Recommendations

The following key activities are planned for the upcoming quarter. Each activity is briefly outlined below.

10.1. Bannu Kick-off Workshop

Due to multiple contributing factors, the kick-off workshop in Bannu has been significantly delayed. Despite repeated attempts by the Implementation Consultants, a series of security-related incidents have continuously postponed the event. Given its importance, the workshop has now been assigned the highest priority and will take place in December 2024/January 2025.

To ensure its timely execution, coordination with relevant stakeholders will be undertaken in advance. A vigilant approach will be maintained to identify a suitable window of opportunity for organizing the workshop. Once favourable conditions arise, the workshop will be conducted without further delay. Accordingly, all logistical arrangements must be prepared in advance, requiring meticulous planning and readiness.

10.2. Institutional Assessment and Context and Physical Assessment

As per the original plan, this activity was to be preceded by the Context and Physical Assessment. However, due to administrative and security constraints, the physical assessment could not be initiated as scheduled. To avoid delays, the team commenced work on the Context and Institutional Assessment instead.

A comprehensive checklist and questionnaire were developed and pre-tested before being finalized. By the end of the reporting quarter, fieldwork had begun, with the team engaging all relevant stakeholders. The fieldwork is expected to be completed in the next quarter, followed by data compilation and report preparation.

10.3. Coordination with Experts

Following an extensive virtual coordination meeting involving 19 national and international experts, all participants have been individually contacted. These experts have been categorized into groups based on their respective fields, with each discipline comprising both national and international experts, addressing the fields of water supply, sanitation, decentralised sewage system and solid waste management.

Each group has been provided with guidelines and relevant excerpts from the bid-winning proposal document to facilitate informed discussions. Given the prevailing security conditions, international experts are unlikely to visit the project corridor. As a result, fieldwork responsibilities will primarily fall on national experts. Through virtual meetings, international experts will provide guidance and oversight to their national counterparts.

Additionally, due to the inaccessibility of five tehsils, even national experts may face challenges in conducting on-site visits. Consequently, alternative methodologies for remote data collection and engagement will need to be devised and discussed.

10.4. Hiring of CSO

Given the dynamic security situation, maintaining strong coordination with all stakeholders is essential for the project's success. The Implementation Consultants have been effectively engaging with government stakeholders, including district administration, Additional Directors of Local Government Elections and Rural Development Department (LGERDD), Tehsil

Municipal Administrations (TMAs), and other relevant authorities. However, engagement with local communities remains limited. To address this gap, the immediate hiring of a Civil Society Organization (CSO) is imperative. The CSO will play a crucial role in facilitating community engagement, ensuring their active participation in project activities. Given the circumstances, expediting this process will be beneficial for achieving the project's objectives effectively.

Annex 1: Letter of Introduction



GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
URBAN POLICY AND PLANNING UNIT
Regional Infrastructure Fund-II, KP (RRMiC)

No: UPU/RIF-II/657

Dated: 31st July 2024

To,

The Deputy Commissioner,
District D.I.Khan.

**SUBJECT: CONSULTATIVE MEETING ON REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE
FUND-II IN KP FOR RESILIENT RESOURCE MANAGEMENT IN
CITIES (RRMiC)' (ADP NO. 220419) (KfW ASSISTED)**

Madam,

The Federal Republic of Germany has approved a new bilateral grant of Euro 17.5 million (Off-budget grant) for improving Resilient Resource Management in the Cities of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. The grant money will be spent to address the infrastructure gaps in the urban centers of five tehsils of District Bannu and four Tehsils of District DI Khan. The basic objective of the proposed investment is to contribute to good governance with a particular focus on equipping the district line agencies with improved tools for effective, participatory, and evidence-based planning, design, and implementation. The funds are made available to support Khyber Pakhtunkhwa in its efforts regarding SDG No.11 'Sustainable Cities and Communities'. For the proposed activities a tripartite agreement has been signed between the Ministry of Economic Affairs Division - Government of Pakistan, KfW (the German Development Bank), and the Planning and Development Department - Government of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.

The Central Development Working Party (CDWP) approved the scheme at a cost of 4620.00 million in its meeting held on 31.10.2022, for the execution of 'Regional Infrastructure Fund-II in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa for 'Resilient Resource Management in Cities (RRMiC)' KfW funded in Bannu and DI Khan districts of KP. Administrative Approval was subsequently issued by the Planning & Development Department, KP on 28th March 2024. AHT Group and Associates has been selected as Implementation consultants for the project.

In this regard, Mr. Ulrich Summit-Head AHT Group, along with his team will visit DI Khan from 31st July 2024 to 2nd August 2024, as well as from 5th August 2024 to 9th August 2024 for a preliminary consultative meeting with the District Administration, the DPO, XEN PHEDs, and TMOs. It is, therefore, requested to please facilitate and extend your support to the project team.

Looking forward to your favorable and timely response.

Adnan Salim
Project Director (RIF-II)
UPU, P&DD

1. Executive Director, UPU
2. PS to Additional Chief Secretary, P&DD
3. PS to Secretary, P&DD
4. PS to Secretary LGE& RDD
5. PS to Secretary, PHED

Annex 2: Kick-off Meeting – Invitation Letter



GOVERNMENT OF KHYBER PAKHTUNKHWA
PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
URBAN POLICY AND PLANNING UNIT (UPU)
Regional Infrastructure Fund-II, KP (RRMiC)

07 August 2024

To,

The Deputy Commissioner
Dear Ismail Khan

Subject: Kick-Off Meeting of RIF II

Dear Madam/Sir,

I take this opportunity to apprise you with pleasure that as per the bilateral agreement, the KfW funded “Regional Infrastructure Fund II (RIF II)” for Resilient Resource Management in Cities (RRMiC) has commenced its working from 01 August 2024. RIF II will be working in two districts of KP, DI Khan and Bannu. The team of the Implementation Consultant is at DI Khan and they have started establishing their initial contacts with the key stakeholders. In due course of time, a similar exercise will also be conducted at Bannu.

It is in this context that I am inviting you for a kick-off meeting to be held at National Club DI Khan on 20 August 2024 at 10:00 AM. It will be a formal inauguration of RIF II, where the participants would be briefed about salient features of the project, its approach, delivery modalities and community participation. Through this interactive briefing session, the team will also be answering your questions, listen to your concerns and will also take down your valuable suggestions. We have tried our best to invite the maximum number of stakeholders from all the five TMAs included in this project.

Detailed program of the intended briefing session is attached for your information please. I do hope that you will be kind and considerate to honor my request for this briefing session of the significant importance.

Your sincerely,

Adnan Salim
Project Director, RIF – II

Annex 3: List of Invitees / Attendees

RIF – II, Kick-off Meeting DIK – List of Potential Participants

(20 Aug 2024)

#	Designation	Appointment	#	Remarks
1	P&DD / PMU / UPU		3	
2	Deputy Commissioner	Distt: Administrator	1	
	Adl: Dy: Commissioner	Distt: Administrator	1	
3	DPO	Distt: Police Head	1	
	DPO Focal Person		1	
4	SE PHED	Divisional Head of PHED	1	
5	XEN PHED	Distt: Head of PHED	1	
6	SDOs PHED	Tehsil Heads of PHED	3	
7	Asstt: Local Govt: & Rural Dev: Department) LGRDD		1	TMA staff are the employees of LGRDD.
8	TMOs	Tehsil Heads of TMAs	5	
9	Assistant Commissioners (ACs)	Tehsil Administrators	5	
10	Dy: Superintendents of Police (DSPs)	Tehsil Police Heads	5	
11	TMA Sub-Engineers		5	
12	Drivers etc.		15	
13	RIF – II Team		8	
	Total:		56	

List of Attendees

LIST OF PRTCPANTS FROM LINE DEPARTMENTS

S.NO	Name	Designation	Office
1	Farhan Khan	ADC	DC Office
2	Arsalan Mahmood	Planning Officer	DC Office
3	Attah Noor	AC	Paharpur
4	Gul Ajab Khan	Superintendent Engineer	PHED
5	Kashif Ali	Sub Divisional Officer	PHED Kulachi
6	Asmatullah	Sub Divisional Officer	PHED-Parova
7	Mateen Ullah	Sub Divisional Officer	PHED- Paharpur
8	Huma Saad	Assistant Director	TMA
9	Lubna Yasmin	Secretary	TMA
10	Fahad Nawaz	Sub Engineer	TMA
11	Hibullah	Sub Engineer	TMA-Paharpur

S.NO	Name	Designation	Office
12	Abdul Rahman	Clark	TMA-Kulachi
13	Owais Qureshi	Assistant Manager	WSSC
14	Hassan Raza	Computer Operator	WSSC
15	Muslim Khan	DSP	Police Darazinda
16	Muhammad Ramzan	Inspector	Police DI Khan
17	Adnan Khan	Local Media	DI Khan
18	Aftab Ali	Local Media	DI Khan

LIST OF PARTICIPANTS FROM REGIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND (RIF)-II

S.NO	Name	Designation	Office
1	Adnan Salim	Project Director	UPU, P&D Peshawar
2	Ulrich Sammet	Project Director	AHT-Germany
3	Ayaz Khan	Team Leader	AHT- DI Khan
4	Nasrullah Khan	Senior Coordinator	AHT- DI Khan
5	Kashif Masood	Water Expert	NEC
6	Hamdan Bangash	Finance Officer	Accountant Cynosure

Note: KfW and AHT team members also participated through online from Germany and Islamabad.

Annex 4: Schedule of Kick-Off Meeting

“Regional Infrastructure Fund II (RIF II)” for Resilient Resource Management in Cities BMZ No. 2018 68 355



RIF II Kick-Off Meeting Program

20 August 2024

Time		Activity	By	Remarks
From	To			
09:45	10:00	Arrival of guests and registration		
10:00	10:05	Welcome to all the participants	Moderator	
10:05	10:10	Recitation from Holy Quran	Anyone	
10:10	10:40	Self-Introduction of the participants		
10:40	10:55	Keynote address	PD/UPU/PMU	
10:55	11:10	Tea break		
11:10	12:00	RIF II presentation, explaining salient features, geographical orbit and implementation modalities	Team Leader	
12:00	13:00	Questions / answers		
13:00	13:15	Closing remarks by: ☐ Deputy Commissioner ☐ KfW		
13:15	13:20	Note of thanks	AHT	
13:20	14:20	Lunch and dispersal		

Implementation Consultant:



As Sub-Consultant:



Annex 5: Photo Documentation of Kick-Off Meeting



Photo 1: RIF – II Introduction by PD



Photo 2: Briefing by Moderator



Photo 3: Question – Answer Session



Photo 4: Question – Answer Session



Photo 5: Question – Answer Session



Photo 6: Audio – Visuals from RRM Mansehra



Photo 7: Group Photo of Participants

Annex 6: Questions and Answers

#	Questions	Answers
1	Sanitation is a problem. All the wastewater is freely being thrown into the river. How this issue will be resolved?	In RIF – II project, we do have plans for the safe and environment friendly disposal of wastewater, depending upon the ground conditions.
2	Why the area is divided in clusters because the problems are same in all tehsils?	For our convenience and planning the area is sub-divided in clusters. The activities in all the tehsils will remain the same. All the components will be implemented in the selected tehsils. Please don't worry, the funds are available for all five tehsils.
3	In cluster 1 we have acute problem of drinking water. How you will identify the actual needs of the area?	By using some survey tools, needs assessment will be done in the all the towns, where priority-based issues will be considered first. As the project is based on participatory approach, so we will need the feedback, inputs from the local community as well. Once all the stakeholders agree on the priority-based issues and it also conforms to the ground realities, we will find the most appropriate solution.
4	How many partners are engaged in this project from consultant side?	Consultants are a consortium of four firms, AHT is the lead consultant, who are joined by NEC for engineering, Cynosure for soft component and BORDA for wastewater.
5	For procurement, what is the bidding process?	Being the project donors, KfW will define the procurement criteria, which will be a binding for us. However, the local contractors can participate in the bidding process, provided they meet the criteria.
6	How and why communities will be involved in government projects and schemes?	All developmental works are done for the benefit of respective communities. Hence, their consultation becomes mandatory and they take its ownership, and take care of its long-term use. They can be involved through NGOs, CBOs and others. In this way their involvement and outreach can be increased and enhanced.
7	Who will hire the CSOs OR NGOs for this project?	Hiring of CSO is the prerogative of KfW and PMU. As implementation consultants, we can assist them in this process. Community mobilization and engagement will be sole responsibility of CSO.
8	How to inform local community?	CSO will be the main source to contact and interact with local community and mobilize them for RIF – II, thereby enhancing the benefit dissemination. The inception phase will be for nine months.
9	It is requested to involve and engage TMA in design and planning phase?	In view of their capacity limitations, TMAs' involvement in designing may not be a feasible preposition. However, during implementation process, all the stakeholders and line departments will be engaged in the entire process.
10	DIK tehsil is the most populous one in the entire district. Its local communities are facing acute problems of drinking water, sanitation and solid waste management. Why this tehsil not included in the project?	City headquarters of all districts in KP are being dealt with by the ADB funded KP-CIP. They will be doing similar activities, at much bigger scale. Hence, GoKP avoided the duplication and wastage of resources.

Annex 7: Invitation Letters by Consultants and DC DI Khan



KfW



To,

The Additional Deputy Commissioner
(Finance and Planning)
Dera Ismail Khan

Subject: RIF – II Project: Appraisal and Briefing to Tehsils Administration

Dear Sir,

In the light of your participation in the kick-off meeting of RIF – II, 20 Aug 2024, and the discussion at your office, 23 Aug 2024, I take this opportunity to seek your kind support. You are well aware that due to a number of contributing factors, despite our timely invitation, representation of tehsils-based officials was very thin. As a follow up of the same, we have visited two tehsils of Paharpur and Parova, but due to prior engagement of those officials, we hardly met a few.

It is in this backdrop that we need your facilitation. It will greatly be appreciated if you may call a meeting of all concerned officials from all the five tehsils, Paharpur, Parova, Kulachi, Darazinda and Daraban at your office. Followings are proposed for this meeting:

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| a. Assistant Commissioners. | c. Tehsil Municipal Officers. |
| b. Deputy Superintendents of Police. | d. TMA Sub-engineers. |

For enhancing their understanding about RIF – II, we'll give them a short presentation and clarify their doubts. Such an arrangement will save our time and enable us for a good planning and early start of project activities, which is direly required by all the TMA beneficiaries. We'll request for holding such a meeting at any convenient date in next week, duly pre-notified to us.

We shall be obliged for this kind favour.

Your sincerely,

Ayaz Khan
International Team Leader
30 August 2024

CC to:

PD, UPPU
AHT



CYNOSURE





OFFICE OF THE
ADDITIONAL DEPUTY COMMISSIONER (F&P)
DERA ISMAIL KHAN
Phone #: 0966-9280067 / Fax #: 0966-9280110

No. 287 /ADC/F&P

Dated 05/09/2024

To

1. Assistant Commissioners Paharhpur, Prova, Kulachi, Daraban, Darazinda
2. Deputy Superintendents of Police Paharhpur, Prova, Kulachi, Daraban, Darazinda
3. TMOs Paharhpur, Prova, Kulachi, Daraban, Darazinda

Subject: RIF – II PROJECTS: APPRAISAL AND BRIEFING TO TEHSILS ADMINISTRATION

Refer to the kick-off meeting held on 20-08-2024 on the noted subject at National Club, D.I.Khan organized by the representatives of Regional Infrastructure Fund – II project.

A follow-up meeting for the same has been scheduled to be held on 12-09-2024 at 10:00 am in the office of the undersigned.

You are informed to attend the said meeting in-person on date, time & venue mentioned above.

ADDITIONAL DEPUTY COMMISSIONER (F&P)
DERA ISMAIL KHAN

No. & Date of Even.

Copy forwarded to:

1. The Commissioner, D.I.Khan Division, D.I.Khan
2. The Deputy Commissioner D I Khan.
3. The District Police Officer, D.I.Khan, with the request to nominate DSPs for their participation in the above mentioned meeting.
4. Ayaz Khan International Team Leader, RIF-II Project
5. PD, UPPU AHT, Peshawar

ADDITIONAL DEPUTY COMMISSIONER (F&P)
DERA ISMAIL KHAN

Annex 8: List of Participants

#	Name	Designation	Office
1	Sara Rehman	DC	DC Office
2	Farhan Khan	ADC (F&P)	DC Office
3	Adnan Jameel	ADC (G)	DC Office
4	Tahreem	Additional AC (HQ)	DC Office
5	Arsalan Mahmood	Planning Officer	DC Office
6	Zahoor Aslam	AD-IT	DC Office
7	Farmanullah	DD-Finance	DC Office
8	Shah Behram	AC	Paroa
9	Syed Arsalan	AC	Darazinda
10	Umar Mukhtar	AC	Darabun
11	Sohny Saleem	AC	Paharpur
12	Naqeeb Ullah	DSP	Paharpur
13	Sharif Khan	DSP	Darabun
14	Inam Gandapur	DSP	Kolachi
15	Muhammad Anwar	Tehsildar	Kolachi
16	M.Faizan	TMO	TMA- Paroa, Barabun, Darazinda
17	Zeeshan Jilani	TMO	Paharpur

#	Name	Designation	Office
1	Ayaz Khan	Team Leader	AHT-DI Khan
2	Nasrullah Khan	Senior Coordinator	AHT-DI Khan
3	Hamdan Bangash	Finance Officer	AHT-DI Khan

Note: AHT international team members could not participate due to poor internet.

Annex 9: List of Participants

#	Questions	Answers
1	How will you conduct the need assessment for all the four project components in all the five tehsils ensuring uniformity?	Need assessment will be conducted through baseline survey, discussions with TMAs, beneficiaries' feedback and visual observation of experts for all the four project components. Hence, uniformity will be ensured through using the same tools.
2	It has been observed that quite a few agencies work in the same field where others are also working. It results in resource wastage. Many organizations and government departments implemented such development projects. How will you avoid such duplication and saturation?	This project area and all the four components have been selected by the GoKP. For avoiding duplication, due to ADB funded KPCiP, RIF II will not be working in district HQ tehsils. In case of any observed duplication, it will be reported to concerned quarters. However, consultants do face some difficulties in data procurement.
3	For fruitful and tangible results, it is mandatory to involve the district administration in the entire process, from need identification right up to the project implementation?	Consultants do realize that district/tehsil administration is the most important stakeholder. Once the need assessment has been finalized, it will be shared with the administration and their contentions will also be accommodated. Furthermore, at the end of inception phase, it will also be shared with all the stakeholders.
4	As per your presentation, RIF – II will be working within the urban limits of all the TMAs. Whereas, PHED is responsible only for rural areas. How come PHED is also being treated as your stakeholder? Please clarify.	It is an amply accepted fact the TMAs have serious capacity limitation, almost in all of their professional spheres. This fact has invariably been accepted by almost all the TMA officials, without taking it as a sarcasm. Hence, new water supply schemes of TMAs are being implemented by PHED as a deposit work. After completion, the schemes are being handed over to TMAs for O&M. As an example, quite a few years ago two tube wells were installed by PHED and upon completion, the same were handed to TMA Paharpur. Even after two decades, the TMA is referring to these tube wells as PHED schemes, which displays a total lack of ownership.
5	Will project interventions be done in only tehsil towns or it can also be implemented in rural areas?	By default, RIF – II is designed to work within the boundaries of tehsils towns, which are comprised upon a number of neighborhood councils (NC). However, there are some tehsils having a rural or peri-urban character, totally based upon village councils (VCs) and without any NCs. The Project will deliberate upon such cases and the issue will also be discussed with district administration and proponents.
6	How the project will help TMAs for solid waste management (SWM) component?	Safe disposal of SWM is the most neglected sector, which has become a menace. Owing to capacity limitations, TMAs are totally unaware about the related risks and threats. RIF – II will coach/educate them about safe SWM practices, including provision of equipment etc. At the same time the respective communities will also be groomed and sensitized.
7	Will the project be providing any mechanical equipment for efficient SWM to the TMAs at tehsil level?	It depends upon a number of variables, like baseline survey, need assessment, quantum of solid waste, location of waste disposal area and many more. During first phase of RIF – II (RRM Mansehra), the Project did help out some of the TMAs.

Annex 10: Photo-Documentations



Photo 8: DC DIK chairing the meeting



Photo 9: Briefing by the Moderator



Photo 10: Briefing by the Moderator



Photo 11: Briefing by the Moderator



Photo 12: Question – Answer Session

Annex 11: Photo-Documentation of TMA Paharpur

Paharpur

The office of TMA is located in the heartland of urban populace, approachable through crowded and narrow streets. It was visited on 21 August 2024. During daytime market hustle and rush, it may become unapproachable by car. Hence, it is advisable to park the car and walk up to their office. Luckily, the team found all the three engineering officers, (i) sub-engineer water supply, (ii) tehsil officer infrastructure and (iii) engineering supervisor. The team could not meet the Tehsil Municipal Officer (TMO) due to his unavailability. The team visited TMA office along with the respective sub-divisional officer (SDO) PHED. Our initial discussions and ground observations are summarized below:

- The town has two old tube wells installed by PHED in 1987 and 2006. One is non-functional due to profusely leaking overhead storage and distribution tank and choked and rusted network of distribution pipes.
- The 2nd one is functional and also has an overhead tank, but cannot be used due to non-existence of distribution pipes network.
- Both the tubewells were commissioned by PHED and handed over to TMA for O&M responsibilities. But as yet TMA is not displaying any ownership. They still call it as PHED's tubewells.
- Quite some time ago, a sealed filter unit was installed at one of the tube wells. It is only operated for functionality of the filter.
- The engineers were not aware about the filtration media. As per them, a few months ago the filtration media has been changed by the manufacturer. Quite a few residents collect water from the filter.
- The RCC (reinforced cement concrete) built storage tank is in a highly dilapidated condition, where quite a few steel bars are exposed to rusting due to weathering action. No efforts have been made for its repairs.
- Most of the city residents are meeting their water needs through shallow local bores, as the water table is barely 8 – 10 m deep. Water contamination has been reported from such sources.
- Potable water has been reported beyond a depth of 20 m. Due to cost effectiveness such bores are very few, affordable by well-to-do residents.
- While discussing the water contamination, none could render a satisfactory answer. The last water sample was tested about three years ago. Luckily the report was inspected, it was a chemical test and was found satisfactory. The biological test was missing.
- Surprisingly, TMA staff were not aware that a well-equipped water testing laboratory is available in the PHED-DI Khan premises.
- No one ever paid any water tariff and TMA equally did not make any such efforts.
- No solid waste dumps or free-flying shopping bags were found in visited parts of the city.
- Side drains were not cleaned, but no oozing out of effluents was noted.
- The team could not meet the AC, due to his unavailability. Luckily the team met the DSP (Deputy Superintendent of Police), who briefed them about the prevalent security scenario. Its summary is presented below:
- Paharpur is relatively much safer than the three western tehsils.
- However, because of its close proximity with Lakki Marwat District and Sheikh Badin National Park complex, some new security challenges have emerged during recent times.
- Some miscreants and looters have also been reported in the scrub forest around north-

western desert of Paharpur, adjoining M-14 motorway.

- Hence, considerable travel discipline and restraints are to be exercised. This area must be cleared at least two hours before the last light.
- The visitor must strictly blend himself with the local dress code, using an ordinary and most common travel vehicle.
- Fancy briefcases, sun glasses and laptop bags must not be used.
- The minimum documents should be brought in, carrying in an ordinary cloth or shopping bag.

A few captioned visuals of TMA Paharpur are attached below.



Photo 13: Overhead storage and distribution tank in a dilapidated condition.



Photo 14: Makeshift yard of machinery parking.



Photo 15: Makeshift yard of machinery parking.



Photo 16: Makeshift yard of machinery parking.

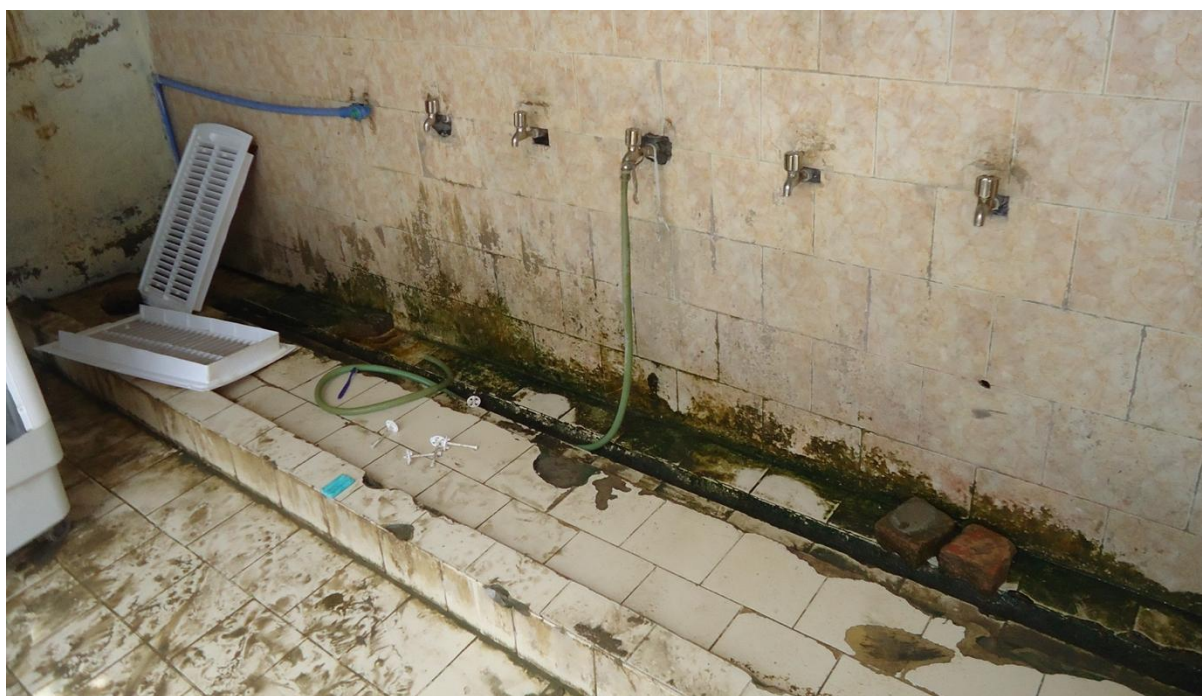


Photo 17: Cleanliness level at filtered water collection point.



Photo 18: Cleanliness level at water filter units.



Photo 19: Sand media filtration unit.



Photo 20: Carbon media filtration unit.

Annex 12: Photo-Documentation of TMA Parova

Parova

In the absence of TMO and the relevant staff, the team met the Chairman Parova Tehsil, briefed him about the Project and answered his questions. His main concern was that RIF – II should not restrict its working within the TMA city limits. Rather, the Project coverage must be extended over the entire tehsil. Drinking water is more direly required in the far-flung rural areas than the city.

On the day of team's visit, a massive public hearing was taking place about the issue of drinking water supply deficiency due to lengthy electricity load shedding. Hence, the engineering staff of TMA was not available.

AC Parova was also not available. But, the team met the DSP. He gave a detailed briefing about the security related landscape, which is summarized below:

- The importance of Parova can be gauged from the fact that Indus Highway, the logistical life-line of KP, is passing through this tehsil.
- Its sensitivity gets magnified due to close proximity with three troubled tehsils of Kulachi, Daraban and Darazinda.
- Parova is also an immediate neighbour of DG Khan and distant neighbour of Zhob (Baluchistan), where terrorists' activities have been reported.
- Police do have weapons, which are meant for maintaining the law and order, not for fighting the terrorists. As compared with the miscreants, police weapons are very basic and primitive.
- Terrorists' presence is also being used by local gangs as a good excuse for dacoities, looting, plundering and roadside robberies.
- Hence, police do not allow night time drive of freight trucks.
- However, despite such limitations, police is doing its best to cope with the situation.
- In addition, Parova is also facing considerable sectarian disturbance due to an age-old simmering rift amongst shia and sunni sects.
- In the light of this panorama, RIF – II team is advised for followings:
 - They should not enter Parova before 9:00 AM and must exit by 4:00 PM.
 - An advance intimation of their visit will be advisable.
 - Must blend in local dress code.
 - They should avoid visiting during shia – sunni tension.

The captioned photo-documentations is shown below.



Photo 21: An audience with Chairman, Tehsil Council, Parova



Photo 22: Unsafe parking yard for precious machinery at Parova



Photo 23: Inundated machinery parking yard



Photo 24: Inundated and makeshift yard of machinery parking.



Photo 25: Inundated office of TMA Parova.



Photo 26: Discussion security situation with DSP Parova.